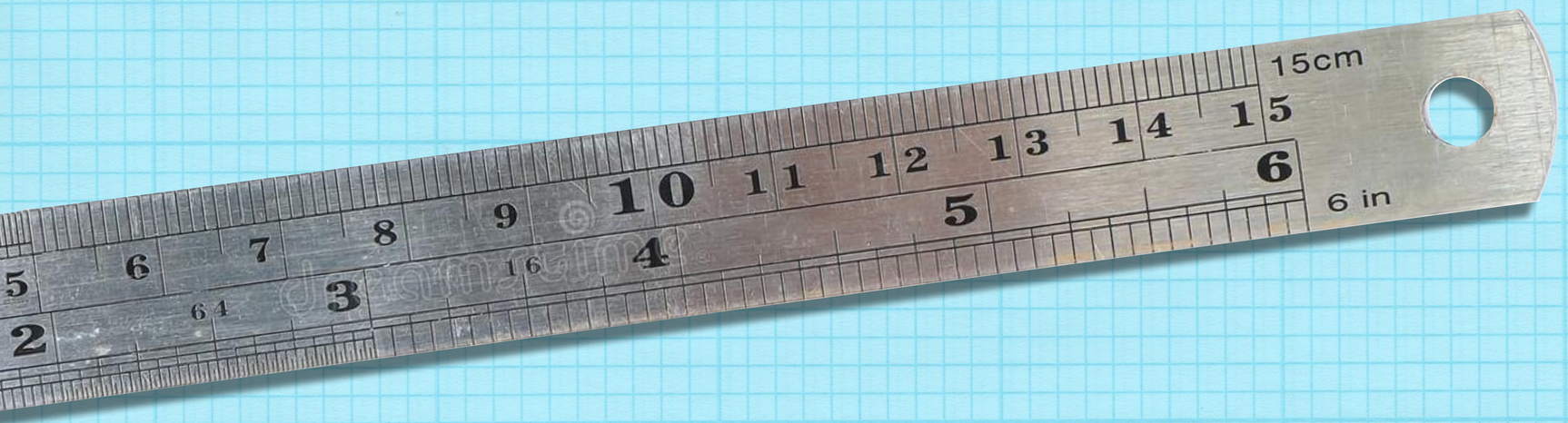
DANIEL BLADE BURRIS

DESIGNING BETTER UX

// Selected projects from my time as a **Senior UX Designer/Design Lead** (2017 - Present)



A BIT ABOUT ME

I began my journey as a UX research and designer at Indiana University where I attained a **B.S. in Human-Computer Interaction/design**. I have spent much of my professional career using the tools and techniques I learned from my coursework delivering user-centered products. I’m proficient in industry-standard research and design methodologies, as well as front-end development technologies. I'm passionate about collaboration and continuous learning, and I’m always seeking to enhance my design practice. Let's work together to create exceptional user experiences!

// My Role
Senior UX Designer/Design Lead

Disclaimer: Please note that much of my UX design work is subject to DoD disclosure restrictions. Certain details have been omitted to protect sensitive information, including PII. Thank you for your understanding.

CASE STUDIES

1. Complete Intranet Design Overhaul

2. User Compliance Tracking Dashboard

3. Office Supply Ordering Application

4. Bug Tracking Application

1 COMPLETE INTRANET DESIGN OVERHAUL

// Background

Our intranet design is outdated, not user-friendly, and lacks mobile optimization, resulting in low employee productivity and frustration. Inconsistent design, complicated navigation, and poor integration with other systems are causing inefficiencies, and employees are struggling to find the information they need. Therefore, a complete design overhaul is necessary to provide a modern and efficient intranet system that will improve productivity, communication, and employee experience.

// Platform

Microsoft SharePoint 2013

// Timeframe

March 2020 - September 2020

// Strategies Employed

User Interviews | Paper Prototyping | Card Sorting

// Goals

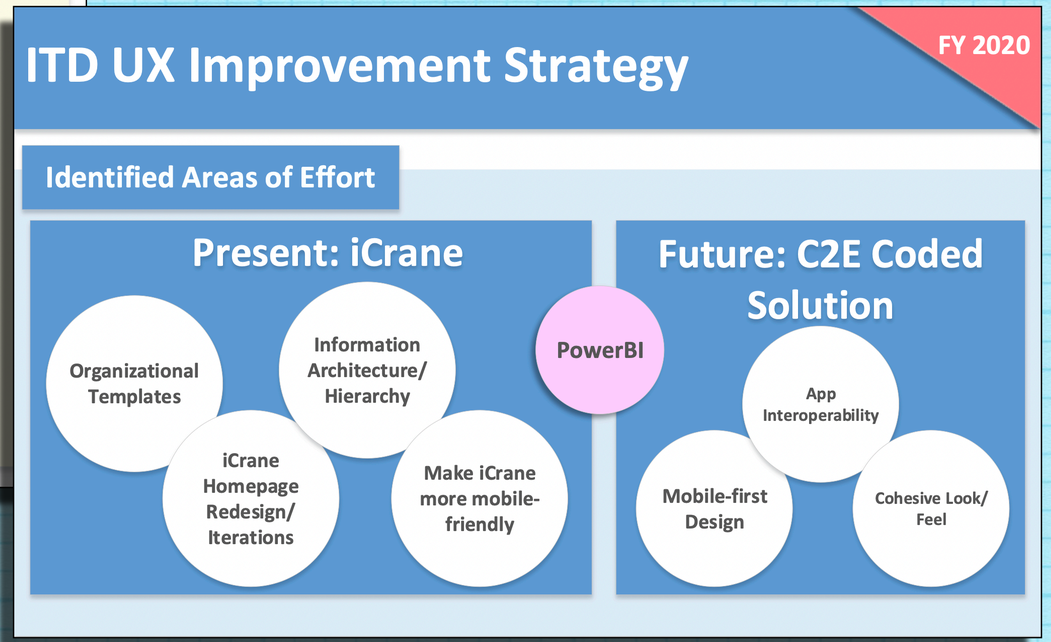
1. Formulate an overarching UX Design Strategy to guide this and future projects
2. Modernize the look and feel of the site, starting with the landing page
3. Create org templates for sub-organizations to implement on their site collections to ensure a more cohesive experience for the users across the environment
4. Make the designs scalable for a wide variety of device aspect rations (mobile friendly)

1 DEVELOPING A UX RESEARCH & DESIGN STRATEGY

Strategy Overview

1) Develop research plan to guide UX research
2) Conduct research and identify areas of improvement for current effort
3) Plan implementation of any proposed changes to address issues identified by research
4) Study the effectiveness of the changes for the target audience (positive/negative/neutral)
5) Assess what works and what doesn't work
6) If positive, iterate. If negative, determine why it didn't work, and try something else
7) Repeat

As my organization's first formal UX improvement project, it was necessary to generate a UX research and design strategy that aligned with the organization's overarching strategic goals to ensure a consistent vision throughout the team



1 GENERATING USER PERSONAS

Empathizing with the user

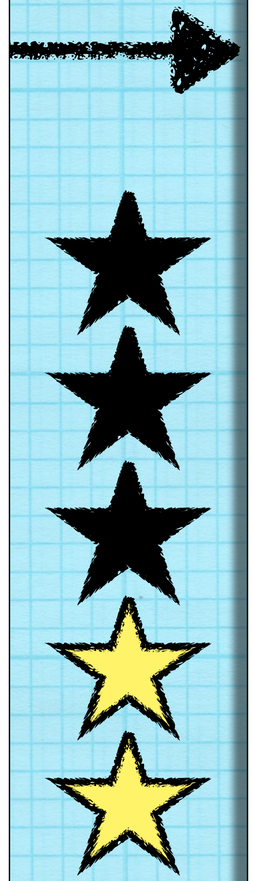
Before we could address our users' needs, we needed a better idea of who our users *were*

At this stage, my team generated over a dozen user personas that represented our user base. We leveraged these personas throughout this project and subsequent UX improvement efforts

1 IDENTIFYING USER PAIN POINTS

// Existing Data

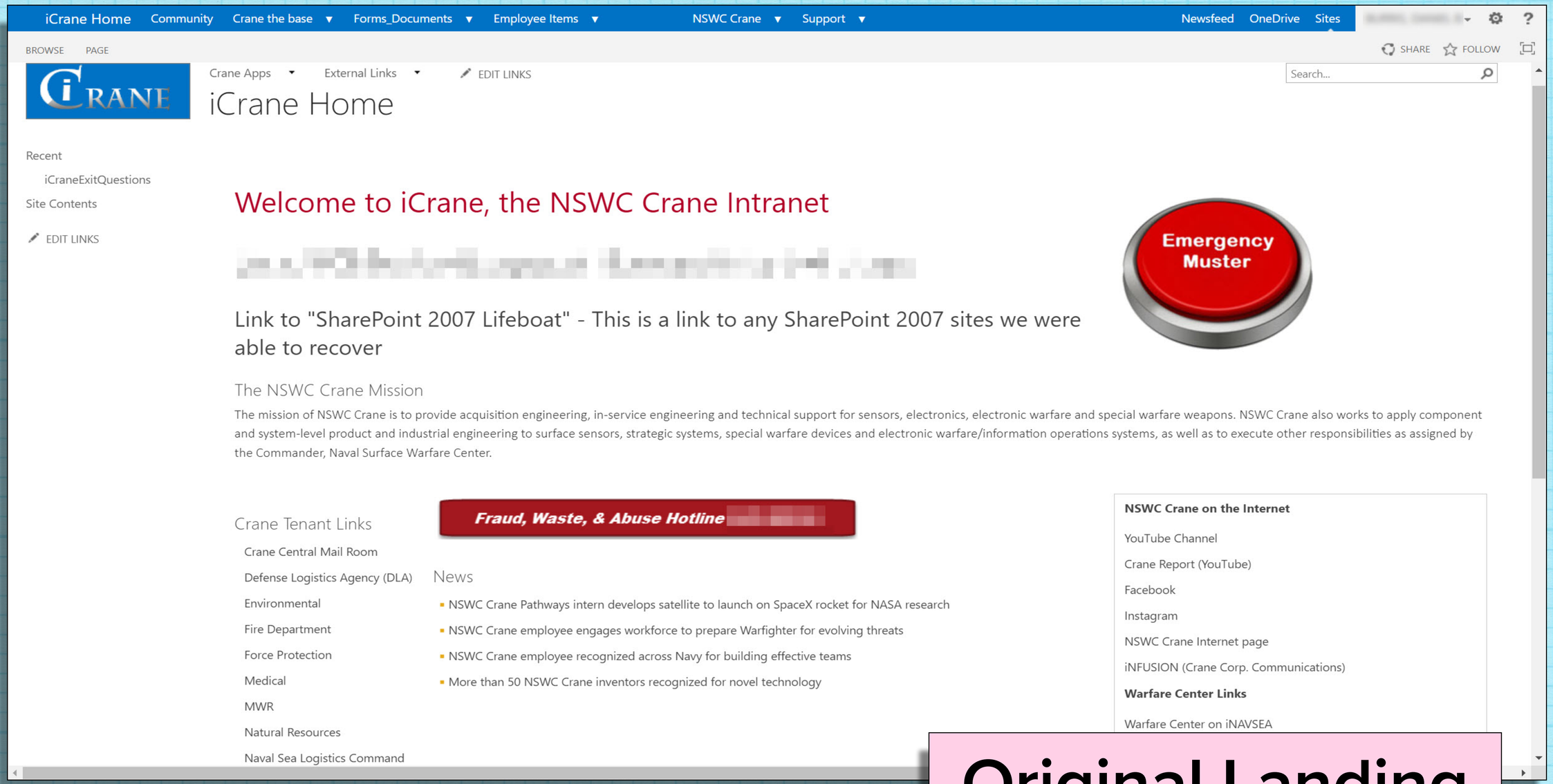
- Existing data showed that our users were having trouble finding the information they needed: **22% of service desk tickets** submitted in the previous 3 months were routing users to the appropriate working group or org function
- Click-through-rate (CTR) of the universal navigation bar **averaged less than 2%** over the previous 3 months leading up to this project, indicating that users were not utilizing the navigation bar
- User satisfaction of the intranet over the previous 3 months was rated **2.3/5** (37 responses)



// Questions for Users

- What information do you expect to find on the landing page?
- What are some things you wish you could change about the landing page?
- What are the things you dislike, if any, about the landing page?
- What are things you like, if any, about the landing page?
- What could be added or removed to make the landing page more useful to you?
- How do you feel about the usability of the intranet as a whole?

1



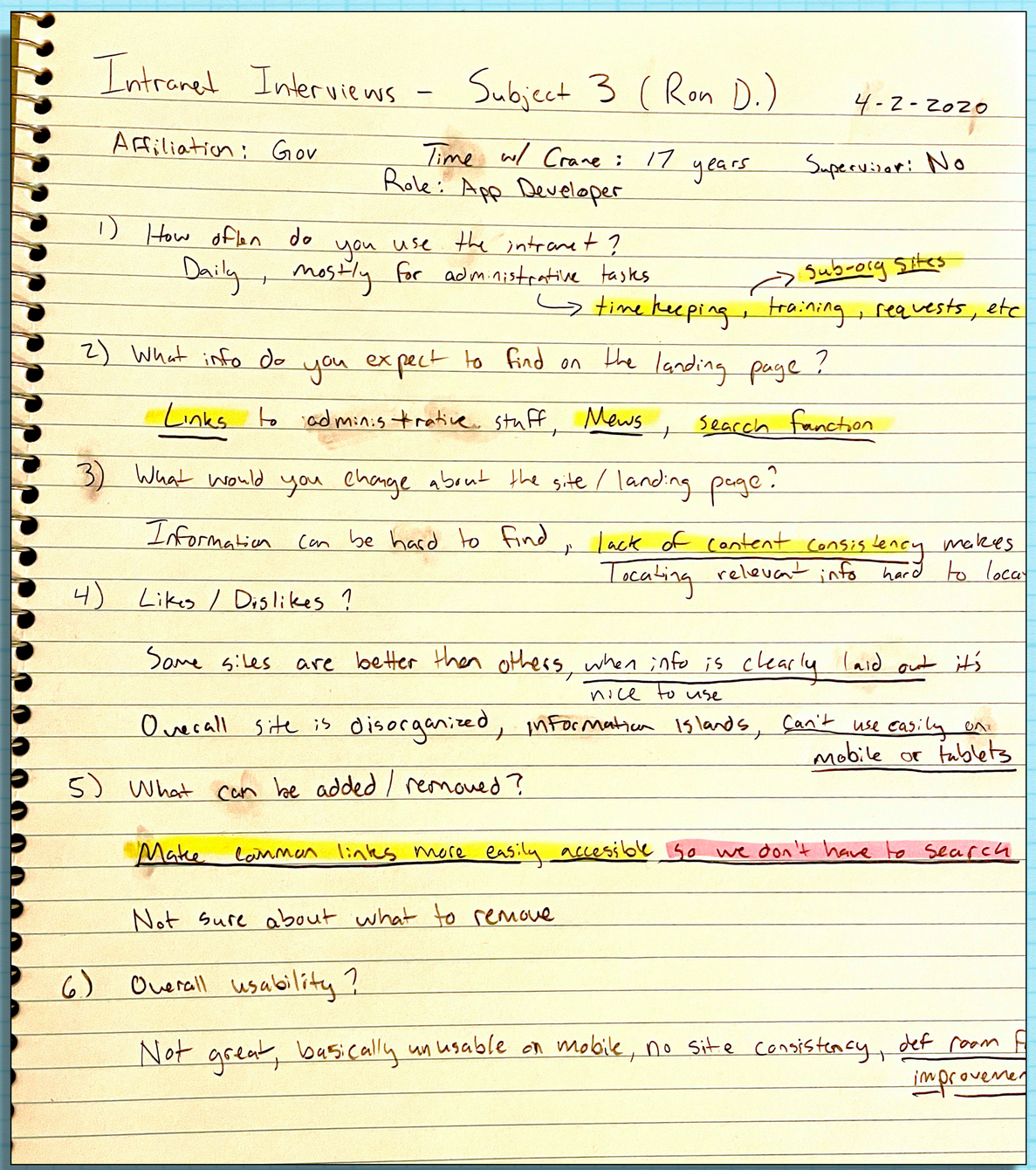
This page was easily the most trafficked page, averaging around **350** unique page views/day in the previous 12 months leading up to this project. That's about 10% of our entire user base

Original Landing Page

1 USER INTERVIEWS

// Preparation

- We sent out a base-wide solicitation of user input on improving the intranet
- We received 24 unique responses from users who were willing to answer the questions we generated from reviewing the data we had on intranet usage
- We selected a group of 16 individuals with varying degrees of job functions, supervisory statuses, and experience with our intranet
- These interviews were conducted over the span of 2 weeks



Intranet Interviews - Subject 3 (Ron D.) 4-2-2020

Affiliation: Gov Time w/ Crane: 17 years Supervisor: No
Role: App Developer

1) How often do you use the intranet?
Daily, mostly for administrative tasks
→ timekeeping, training, requests, etc
→ sub-org sites

2) What info do you expect to find on the landing page?
Links to administrative stuff, News, search function

3) What would you change about the site / landing page?
Information can be hard to find, lack of content consistency makes locating relevant info hard to loca

4) Likes / Dislikes?
Some sites are better than others, when info is clearly laid out it's nice to use
Overall site is disorganized, information islands, can't use easily on mobile or tablets

5) What can be added / removed?
Make common links more easily accessible so we don't have to search
Not sure about what to remove

6) Overall usability?
Not great, basically unusable on mobile, no site consistency, def room f improvemen

1 REVIEWING DATA, GENERATING INSIGHTS

// Noteworthy Observations

- 13 of the 16 interviewees mentioned utilizing the **Search function**
- All of the interviewees had visited the landing page within the **last 5 business days**
- Half of interviewees mentioned that they would like to see **links to common functions** on the landing page
- 12 interviewees mentioned they would like to see **news** featured more prominently on the landing page

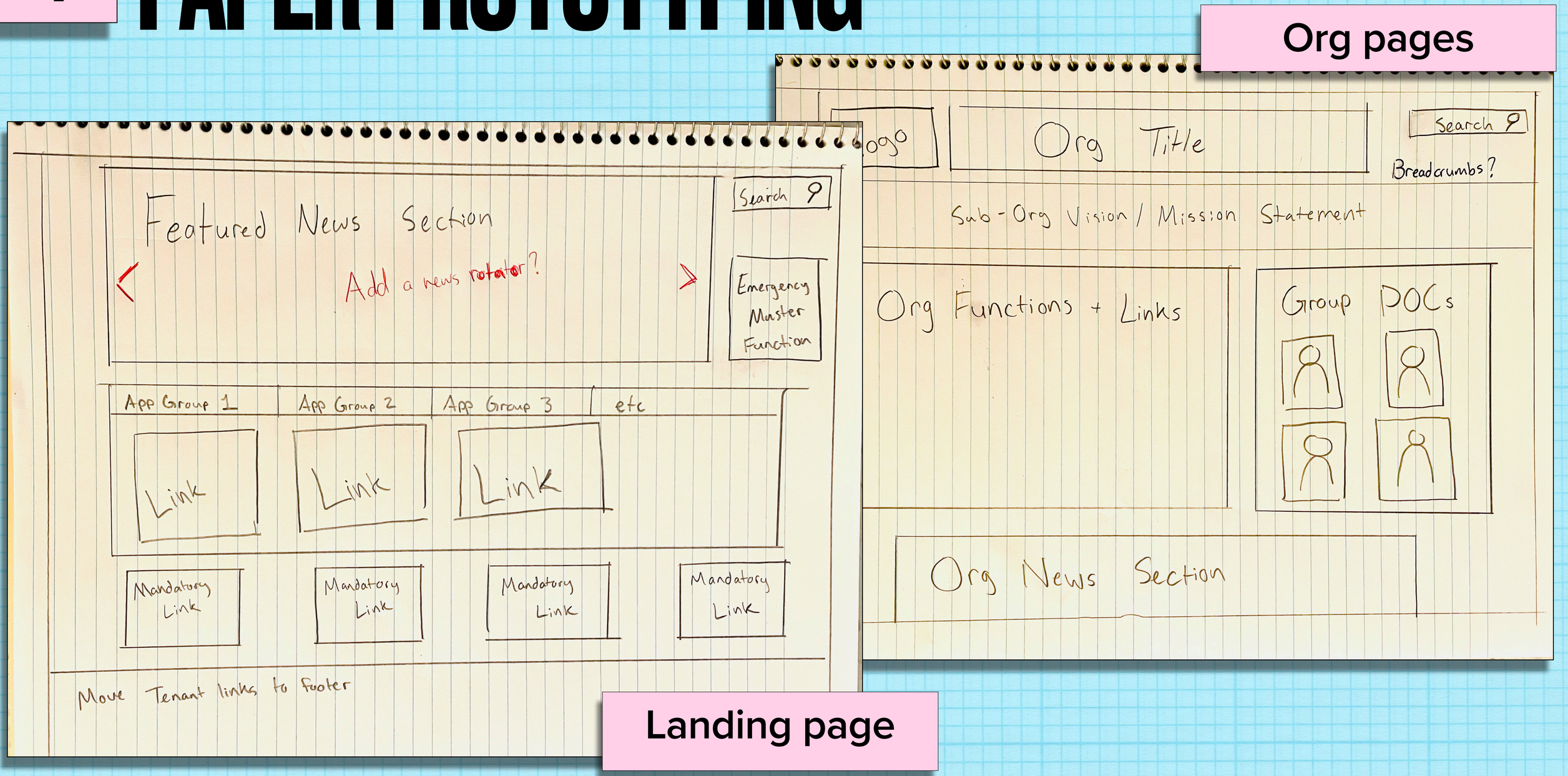
// Common Complaints

1. Relevant **info is hard to find**
2. Information **layout is inconsistent** from sub-site to sub-site, makes finding common info (such as function POCs) hard to locate
3. Intranet is **basically unusable** on mobile devices

// Common Likes

1. The **Search function** on the landing page is handy, but the results could be more accurate
2. **News** was frequently mentioned as being one of the main reasons people utilize the intranet, regardless of role, affiliation, or supervisory status

1 PAPER PROTOTYPING



1 PROTOTYPING LANDING PAGE

Unclassified

Information Technology

icrane.nmci.navy.mil/sites/IT/SitePages/Home.aspx

iCrane Home | Community | Crane the base | Forms_Documents | Human Resources | NSWC Crane | Support | OneDrive | Sites

SHARE | FOLLOW

Search

To clean up search results, we conducted a site content audit and removed orphaned, outdated, and duplicate page results

Base-wide News

App Group 1 | App Group 2 | App Group 3

Emergency Muster

Link	Link	Link	Link
Audience Tag	Audience Tag	Audience Tag	Audience Tag

‘Emergency Muster’ rolled into the featured links section to clean the aesthetic

Landing page redesigned to feature news at the forefront

Search box maintained position at top right, enlarged to be easier to see

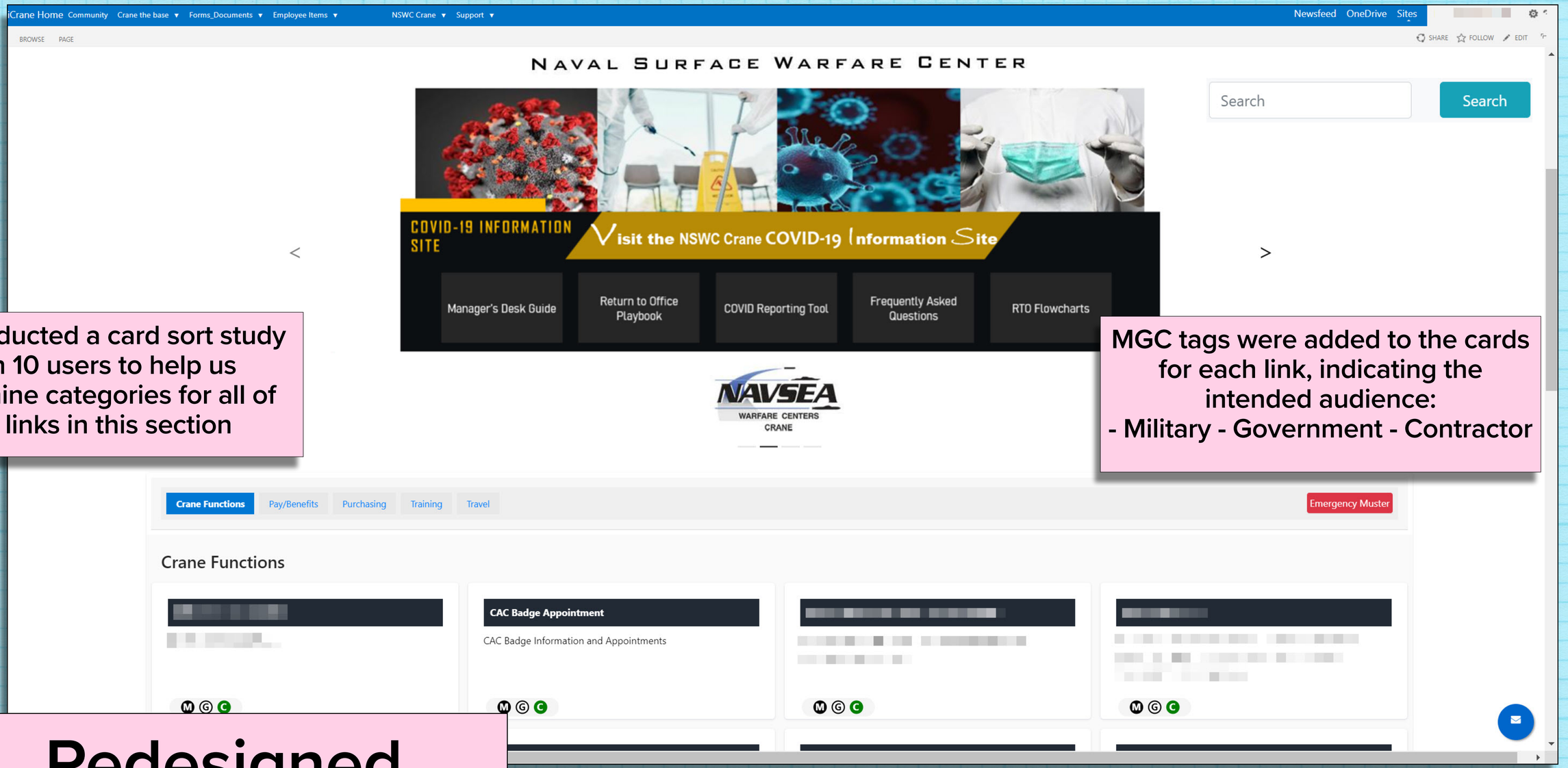
Commonly used links are sorted and featured in a link section immediately below news section

1

Redesigned Landing Page

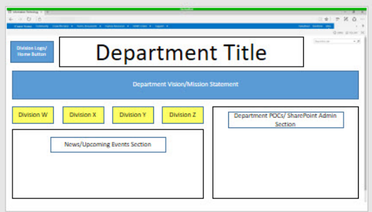
We conducted a card sort study with 10 users to help us determine categories for all of the links in this section

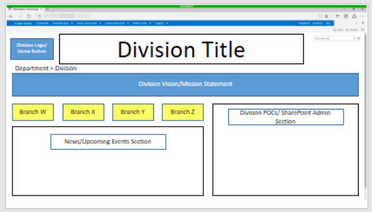
MGC tags were added to the cards for each link, indicating the intended audience:
- Military - Government - Contractor

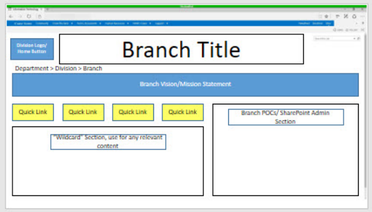


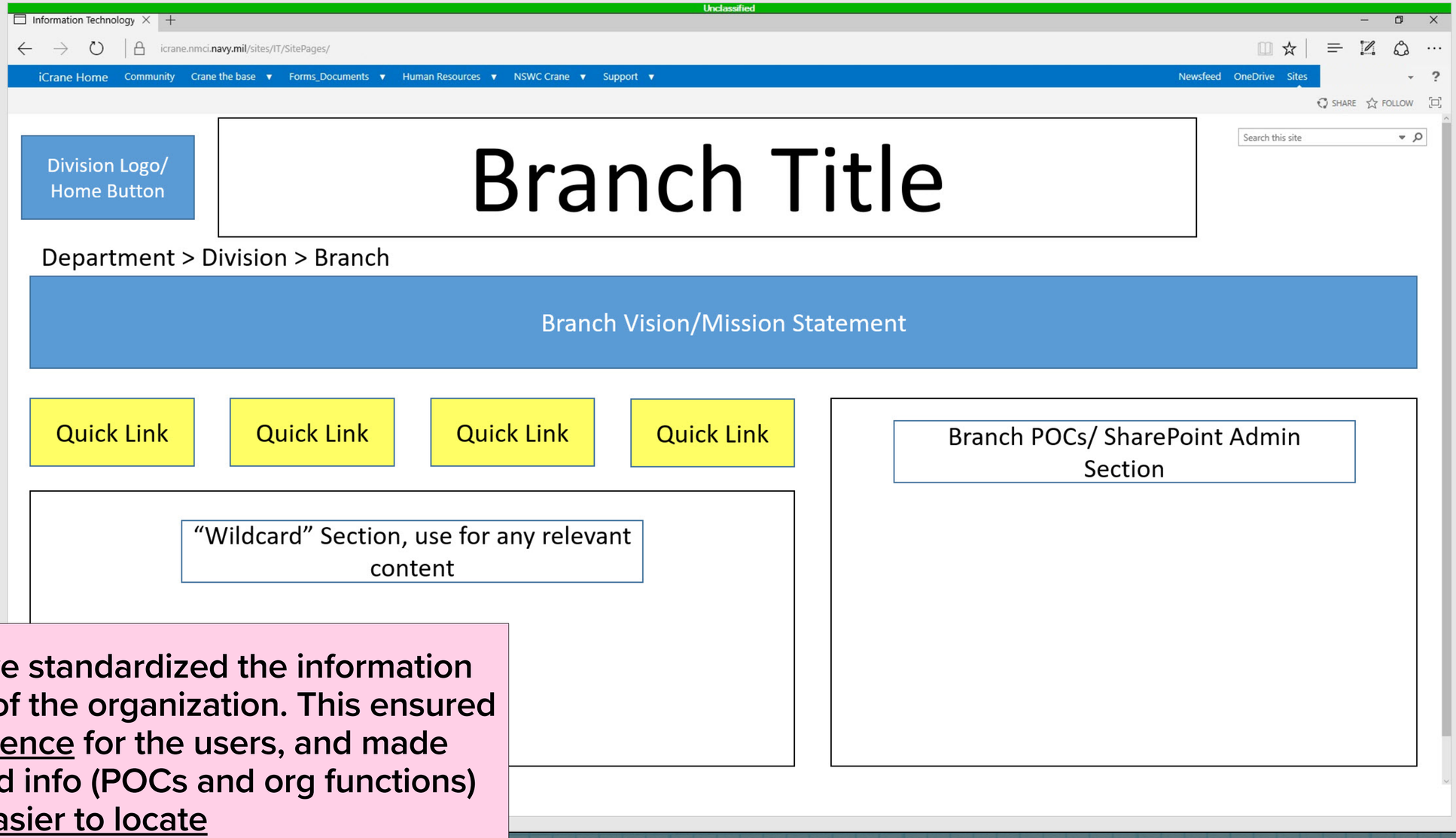
We leveraged Bootstrap CSS libraries to ensure all site components scaled appropriately across a variety of screen ratios

1 PROTOTYPING ORG PAGES









For the org sites, we standardized the information layout at each level of the organization. This ensured a <u>cohesive experience</u> for the users, and made commonly searched info (POCs and org functions) <u>easier to locate</u>

1

Org logo became org banner

Org news section placed beneath org POCs and Functions

Site breadcrumb trail moved to top left, ensuring users knew where they were in the org hierarchy

Redesigned Org Page

We added a floating feedback button in the bottom right that users could use to submit comments to the site owners

1 PROJECT OUTCOMES

// Recap of Key Changes

- Most heavily trafficked page (landing page) was overhauled to showcase base-wide news, links to common functions (with audience targeting), and a more heavily-emphasized search function
- Site contents were audited to clean up search results, making it easier for users to find the info they need
- We generated and implemented org page templates to ensure that common org information (POCs, functions, etc) were in the same spot for each org
- Leveraged Bootstrap CSS libraries to build out the redesigned pages, enabling them to be better accessed and utilized on any device

// Metrics of Success

- Service desk tickets soliciting information users couldn't find on the intranet **fell from 22% to 13%!**
- Cleaning up the search results after the site content audit made it easier for our users to find what they were looking for
- Most importantly, user satisfaction of the intranet in the 3 months following the rollout of the redesign **went up to an average of 4.5/5**, a dramatic improvement of the 2.3/5 average measured 3 months prior to project initiation

2 USER COMPLIANCE TRACKING DASHBOARD

// Background

Our Cyber Security Workforce (CSWF) program office was wanting a user dashboard where program members can go to easily submit completed trainings and track their compliance for the current calendar year. Currently, members seem to be having trouble finding where to submit their trainings and are confused about how much they need to do in order to be compliant. The CSWF program team currently receives a high volume of member requests pertaining to those two aspects of the program, so it is necessary to build a more individualized member program compliance dashboard.

// Platform

Microsoft SharePoint 2013

// Timeframe

May 2020 - July 2020

// Strategies Employed

User Observations | User Stories | Story Mapping | User Testing

// Goals

1. Redesign the user training input dashboard to be easier to submit trainings
2. Implement a visual aid that conveys a user's training completion status for the current calendar year
3. Reduce the volume of member inquiries to the program team from members inquiring about the training compliance

2 IDENTIFYING USER PAIN POINTS

// Existing Data

- We did not have as much quantitative data for this project as we did in the first case study
- We did have plenty of anecdotal evidence from program managers and members that the current training tracking had room for improvement
- According to the program managers, they were receiving an average of around **10 requests/ week** from members asking about where to input their training and/or how many credit hours they needed for the calendar year

// What We Need to Know

- What was causing users to reach out for help to the program team?
- How can we make submitting training more intuitive for program members?
- How can we make viewing program requirements easier for program members?

// Finding Answers

- To isolate the issues and answer those questions, we decided to observe program members as they attempted to log their trainings without assistance
- We would use key insights from these observations to guide our designs that would address those issues

2 USER OBSERVATIONS

// Conducting Observations

- We reached out to 5 program members to see if they would allow us to observe them navigating and submitting some trainings they had recently taken
- We ended up silently observing 3 of them attempt to complete that task
- Notes take from these sessions helped us formulate some user stories that we would use to help guide our dashboard development

“I wish the training log was easier to find”

“Not sure what the current requirement is”

“I just wait for the PM to tell me I need more”

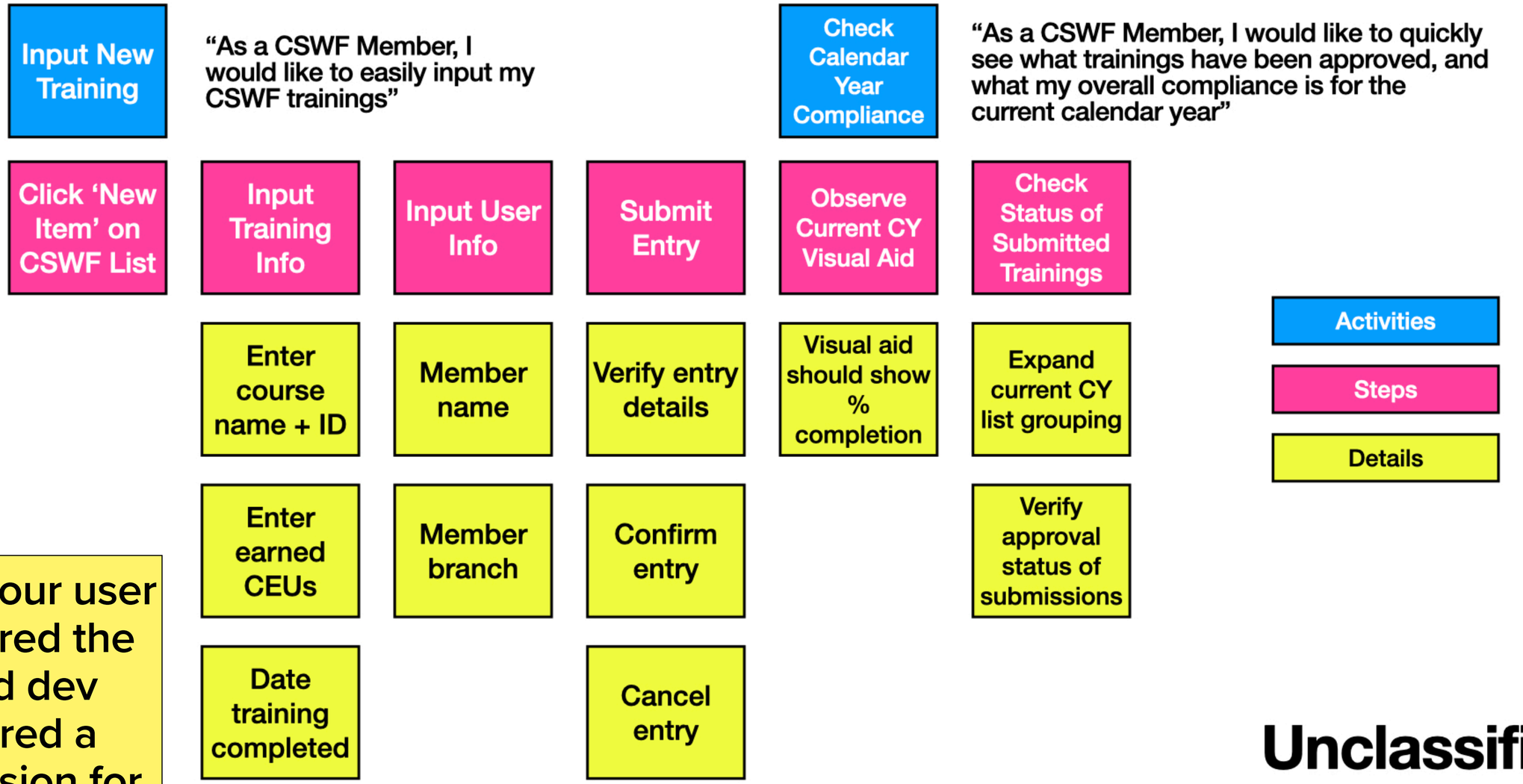
User Observations - Subject 1 (Ian S.) 05-6-2020

Task 1 - Submit a new training
- Searched 'CSWF' on iCrave homepage
- user confused about where the training log is located on CSWF site
- user bounced around a while before finding the training log
- clicked 'new item' and input course info
- "I've done this a lot before, always have trouble finding where to go"
- "Wish the training log was on the CSWF homepage. Or easier to find"

Task 2 - Check Your Compliance for CY 2020
- "I'm not even sure what the current requirement is for this year. It seems to change every year"
- user goes back to training log
- "I can see the trainings I have submitted, and then I just count the credits for the ones that have been approved"
- "Normally I just wait for the PM to tell me I need more trainings"

2

User Story Mapping

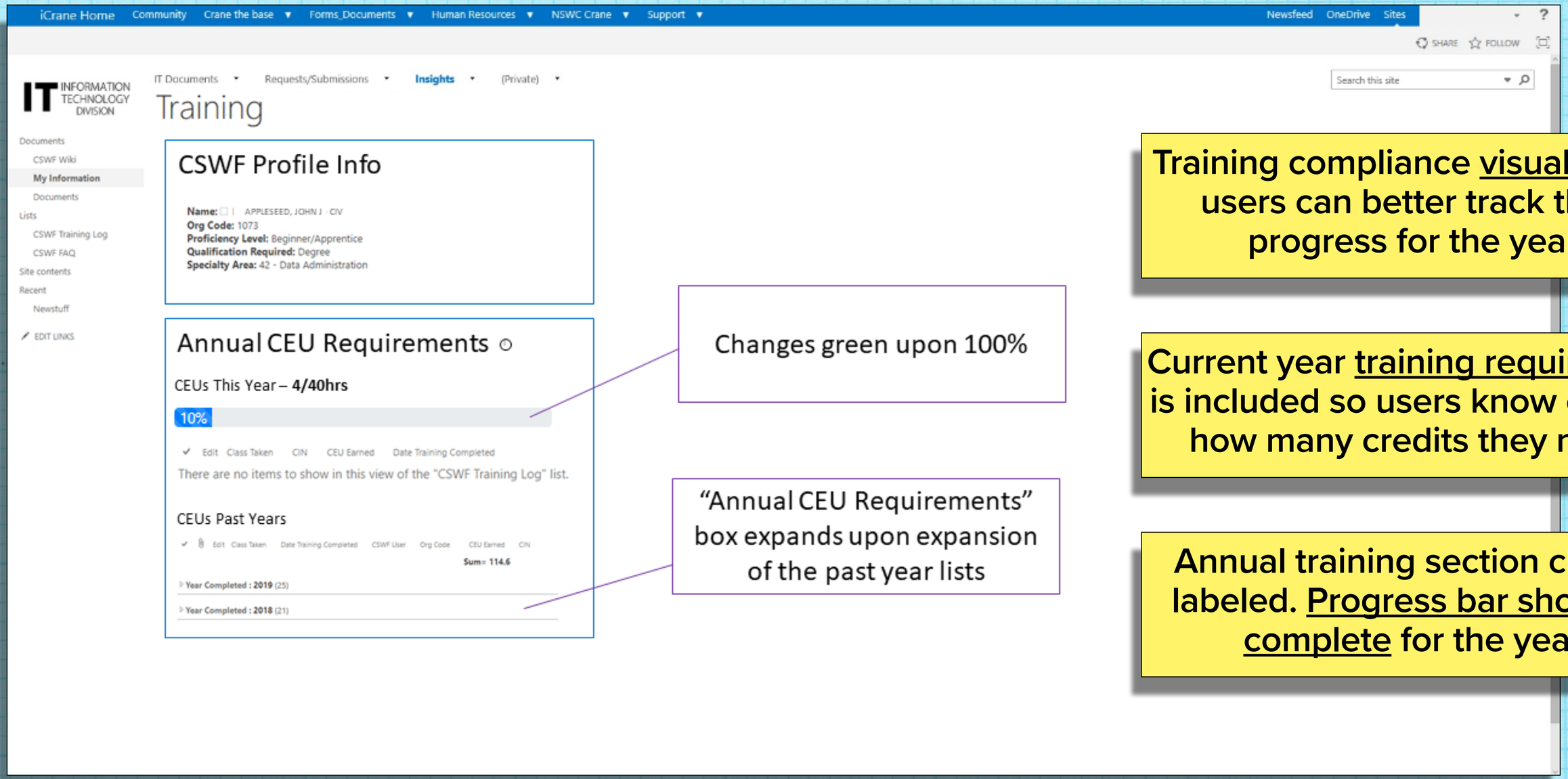


Mapping out our user stories ensured the design and dev teams shared a consistent vision for the product

Unclassified

*Digitization of post-it note mapping session

2 PROTOTYPING TRAINING DASHBOARD



Changes green upon 100%

"Annual CEU Requirements" box expands upon expansion of the past year lists

Training compliance <u>visual aid</u> so users can better track their progress for the year

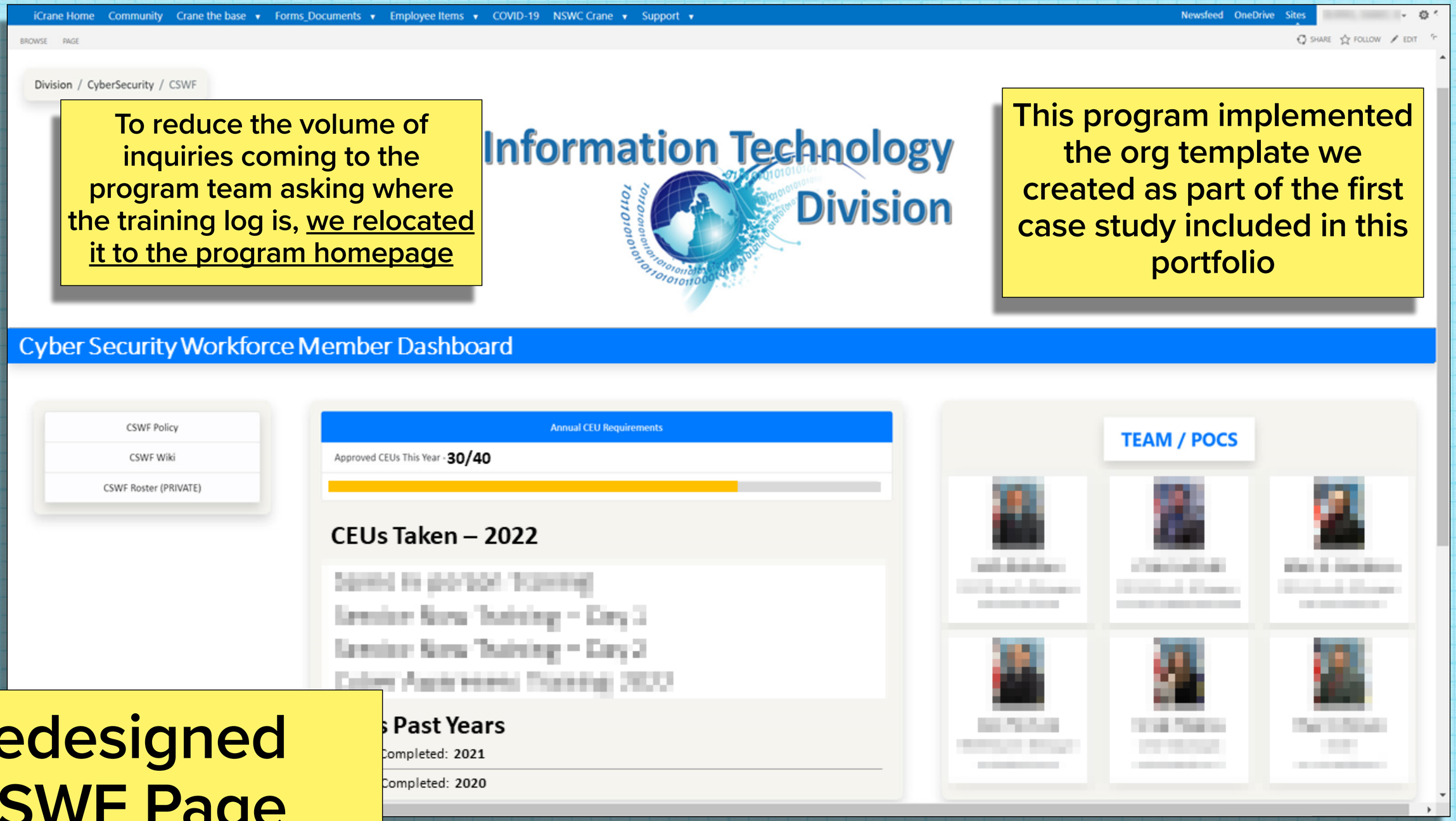
Current year <u>training requirement</u> is included so users know exactly how many credits they need

Annual training section clearly labeled. <u>Progress bar shows % complete</u> for the year

2

To reduce the volume of inquiries coming to the program team asking where the training log is, we relocated it to the program homepage

This program implemented the org template we created as part of the first case study included in this portfolio



Redesigned CSWF Page

2 PROJECT OUTCOMES

// Recap of Key Changes

- During the research phase of this project, the CSWF program managers implemented the org page templates from the previous case study
- Originally, the training log that program members used to input their trainings was on its own page within the CSWF program site collection. We relocated that log to the redesigned program home page so that users didn't have to do additional searching
- A visual aid status bar was added above the training log to indicate to the users their completion status for the year
- To address user confusion surrounding what the annual training requirement was, we added the official training threshold value to the visual aid

// Metrics of Success

- Following the launch of the redesign, the program team saw member requests for training and logging drop from ~10/week to ~5/week. **A 50% decline!**
- We asked the same 3 program members we observed as part of our research to complete the same two tasks, and their testimonials of the new dashboard were **overwhelmingly positive!**

"The new dashboard is fantastic! I can find everything I need much more quickly now"

"I really like the progress bar, gives me a better idea of how much training I still have to do"

3 OFFICE SUPPLY ORDERING APPLICATION

// Background

The Office Supply branch, responsible for procuring and distributing office products for the rest of the organization, is wanting an all-inclusive new application to help manage supply orders. Currently, the team uses a mix of SharePoint lists, workflows, and emails to manage supply orders, which is cumbersome and requires a lot of manual activities. The new application should allow users to browse supply offerings, use saved budgeting codes to ‘pay’ for orders, view past orders, and be able to request new supplies to be added to Office Supply offerings.

// Platform

Microsoft PowerPlatform (Power Apps)

// Timeframe

July 2022 - January 2023

// Strategies Employed

User Stories | Story Mapping | Wireframing | A/B Testing

// Goals

1. Design an intuitive Power App interface that allows users to view available Office Supply products and submit orders for those products
2. Ensure that app interface scales appropriately for laptops and tablets

3 STRATEGIES

My primary approach for this project was using user story mapping and flows. This helped me visualize how users would navigate the screens within the application

User Story Mapping

Activities | Steps | Details

Create Payment Method	"As an OS user, I would like to be able to save my funding info for recurrent purchases"		Order Products	"As an OS user, I would like to submit an order for a few different office supplies"			"As an OS user, I would like to view my submitted orders"	View Submitted Orders
Navigate to Payment Section	Input Funding Info	Save Payment Info	Click Search Bar or Browse by Categories	Add Product(s) to Cart	View Cart	Checkout		Navigate to Orders Section
Nested in hamburger menu	Budget code	Edit payment info	Product categories listed on left	Click into product details	Click cart icon	Confirm products and quantities		Nested in hamburger menu
	Authorizing authority	Confirm payment info		Adjust quantity		Select payment method		
	NWA	Cancel payment info		Click 'add to cart'		Submit order		

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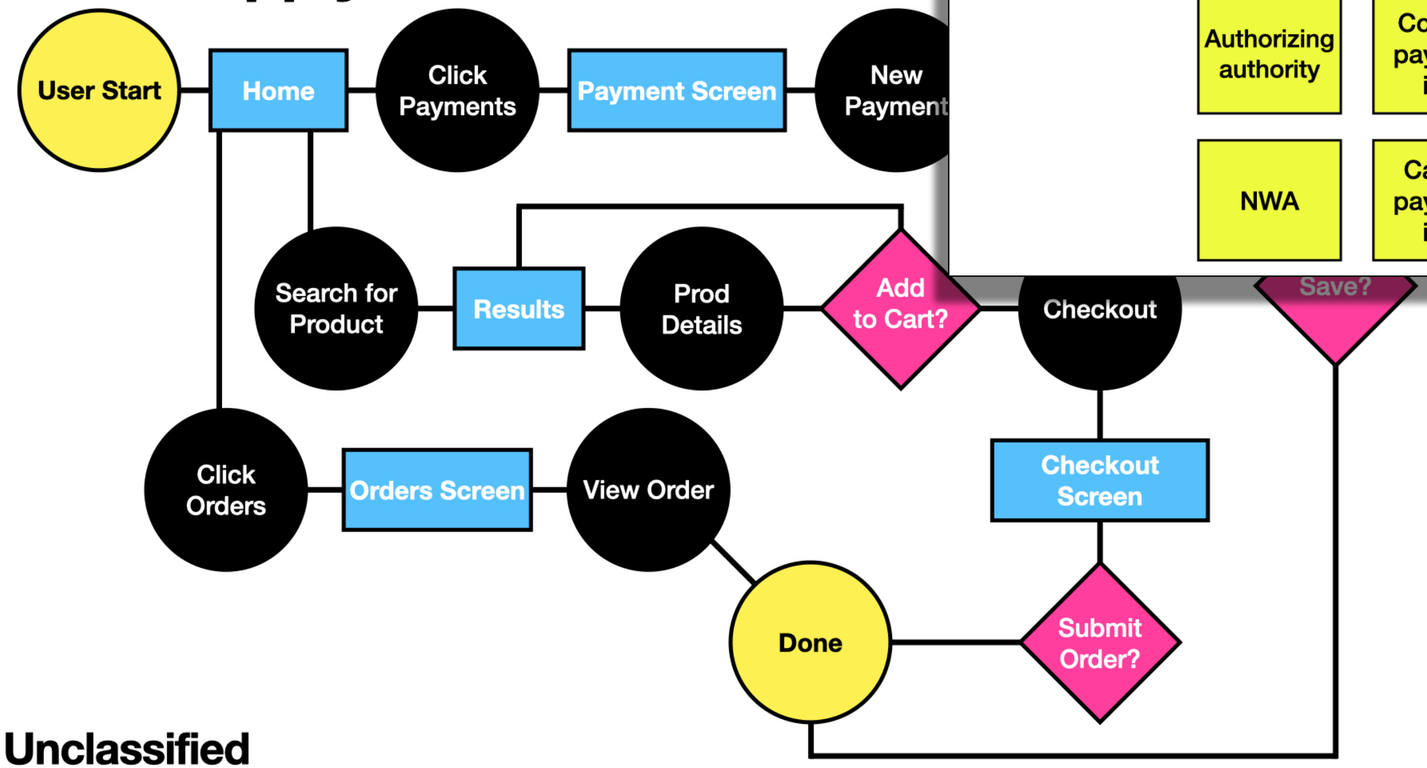
Office Supply User Flow



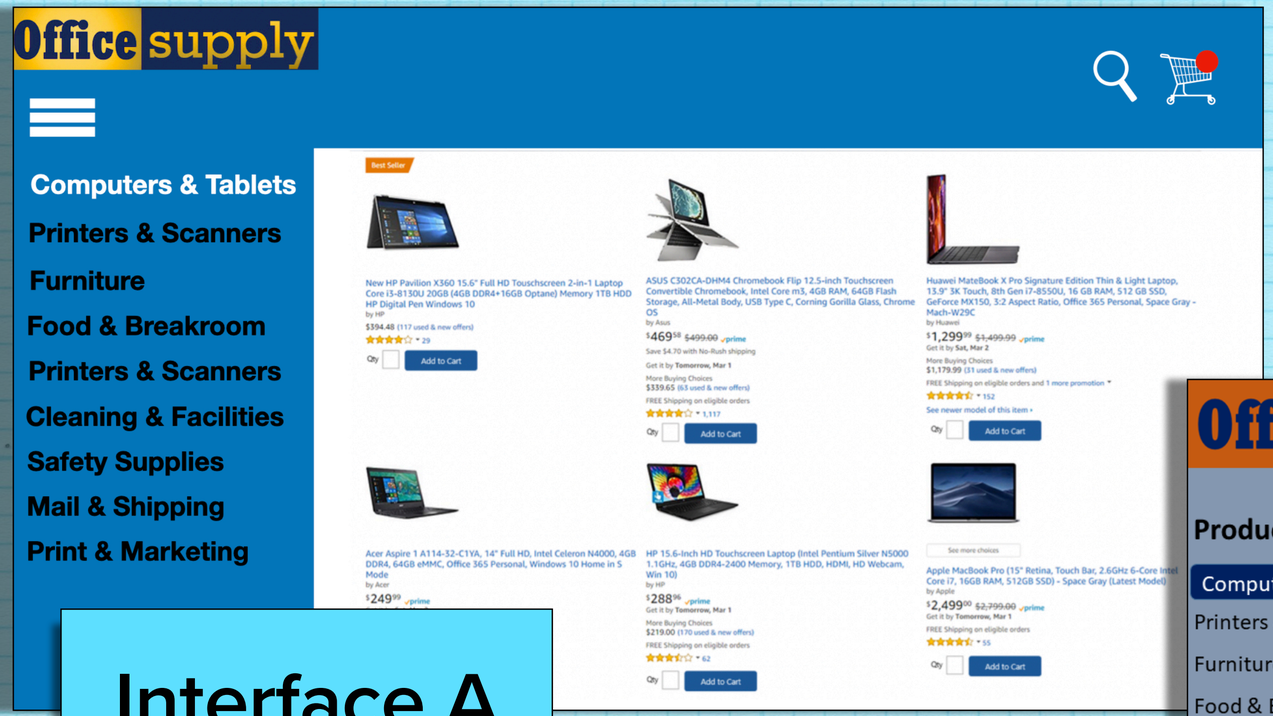
Unclassified

The existing front end for this business function wasn't much more than some basic forms on a SharePoint site. The Office Supply team was really wanting to take advantage of our newly-acquired Power Platform to build a more robust supply ordering interface

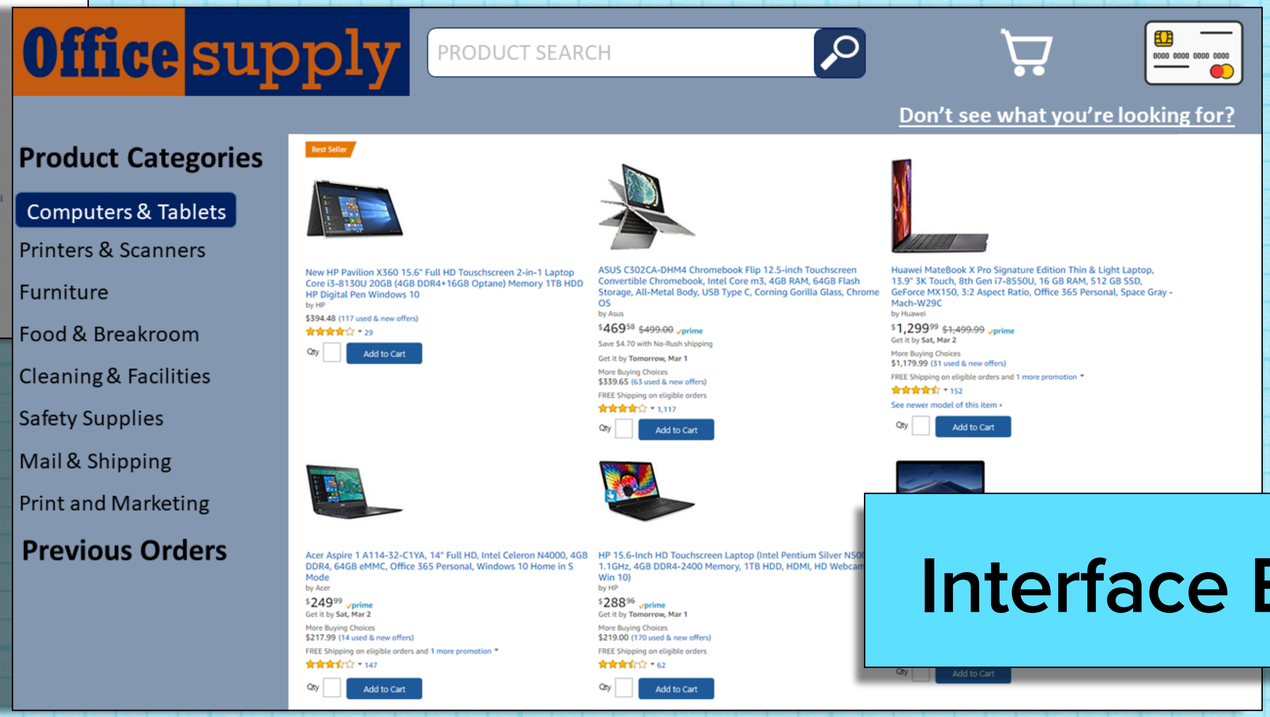
3 DESIGN CONCEPTS

// Input From Users

- To generate some layouts, our team interviewed users who routinely submitted supply orders to see what they would like to see in an interface
- Additionally, it made sense to us to draw inspiration from ordering interfaces that already existed in the private sector (Amazon, etc)
- We combined the user insights with cues from other digital storefronts to generate 2 potential interfaces



Interface A

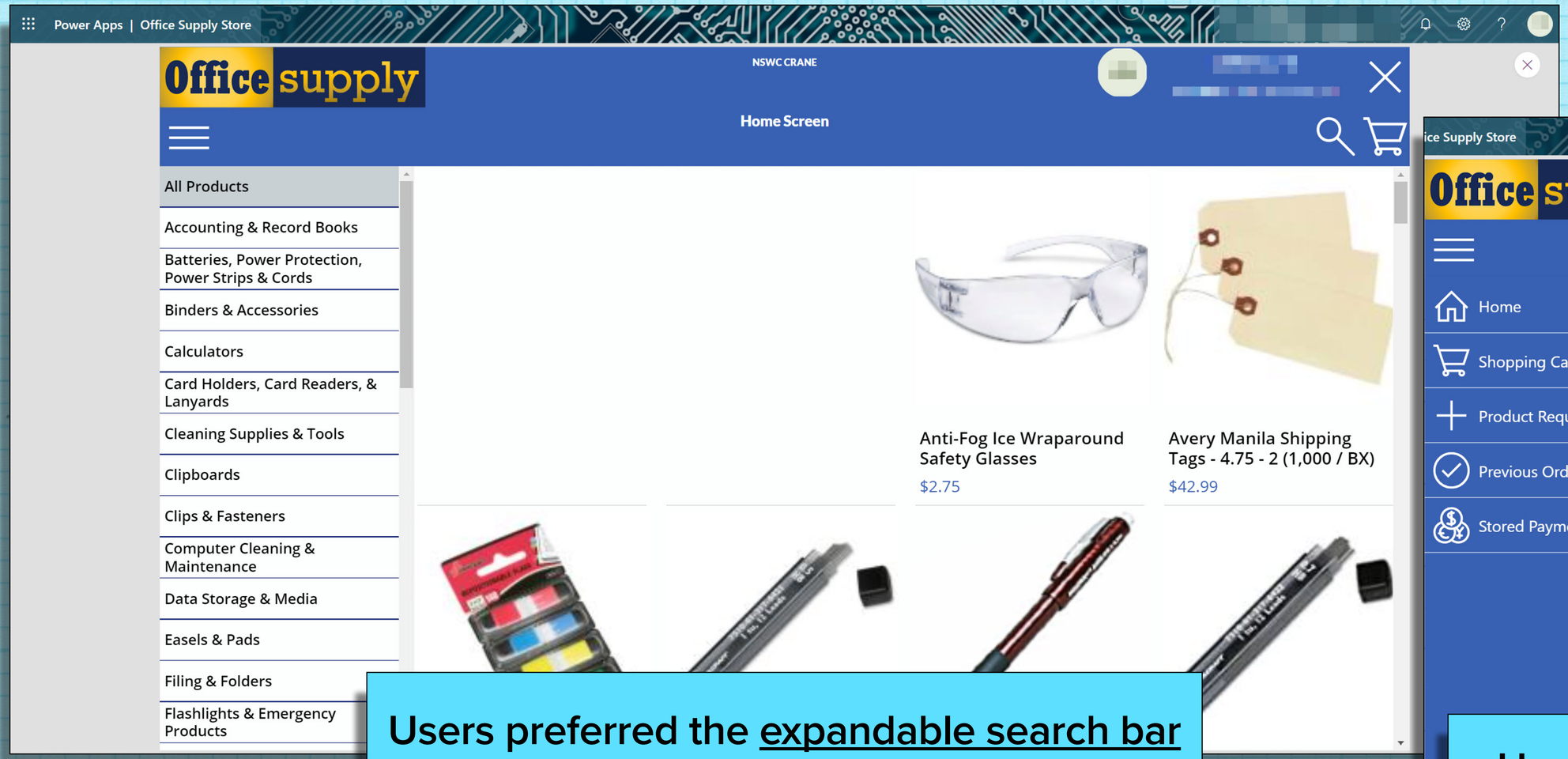


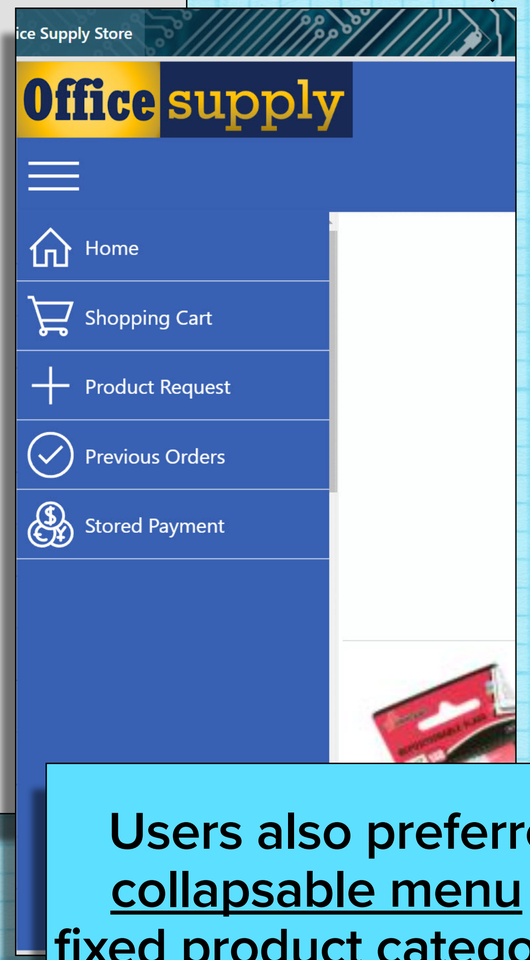
Interface B

I created wireframes of these two interfaces that users could use to simulate completing an order. I then conducted AlB testing to see which design users preferred

3 INSIGHTS FROM A|B TESTING

WINNER: INTERFACE A





Users preferred the <u>expandable search bar nested in the upper right corner</u> to the fixed search bar in the middle of the header

Users also preferred the <u>collapsable menu</u> to the fixed product category menu

3 PROJECT OUTCOMES

// Recap of the Process

- This pre-existing ordering application was mainly a series of forms on a SharePoint site. The process was not intuitive and often resulted in user errors and delayed order processing
- To design the user interface from scratch, we generated users stories describing the users' interactions within the application
- We also generated user flows to help us help guide our development of the different screens we would need
- Using input from users of the old ordering process, and combining that input with design cues from established, well-known purchasing interfaces, we generated 2 variants for users to test
- A|B testing showed us which aspects of the designs to include in our initial roll-out of the app

// Metrics of Success

- There was no existing user experience data for the pre-existing form ordering process. However, the Office Supply team was targeting an average user satisfaction of the new app to be at least 4/5
- We solicited user feedback in the weeks following the app launch. User satisfaction **ranked at 4.5/5**, exceeding the Supply team's goal!
- In a rollout of a minor version release 4 weeks after the initial launch, we added a feedback section in the nested menu. This gave our users an easy avenue to suggest features/ improvements for future releases

4 BUG TRACKER APPLICATION (FIGMA)

// Background

In response to the growing need for an efficient bug management solution within our app development team, we embarked on creating a specialized application designed to streamline the bug reporting and resolution process. The primary objective was to develop an app that could seamlessly receive bug reports from various applications, automatically assign them to the appropriate developers based on predefined criteria, and function as a straightforward ticketing system. This app aimed to enhance productivity by reducing manual effort, improving the accuracy of bug assignments, and ensuring timely resolutions.

// Platform

Microsoft PowerApps

// Timeframe

July 2024 - September 2024

// Strategies Employed

Ideation | User Stories | Paper Prototyping
User Interviews | Wireframing

// Goals

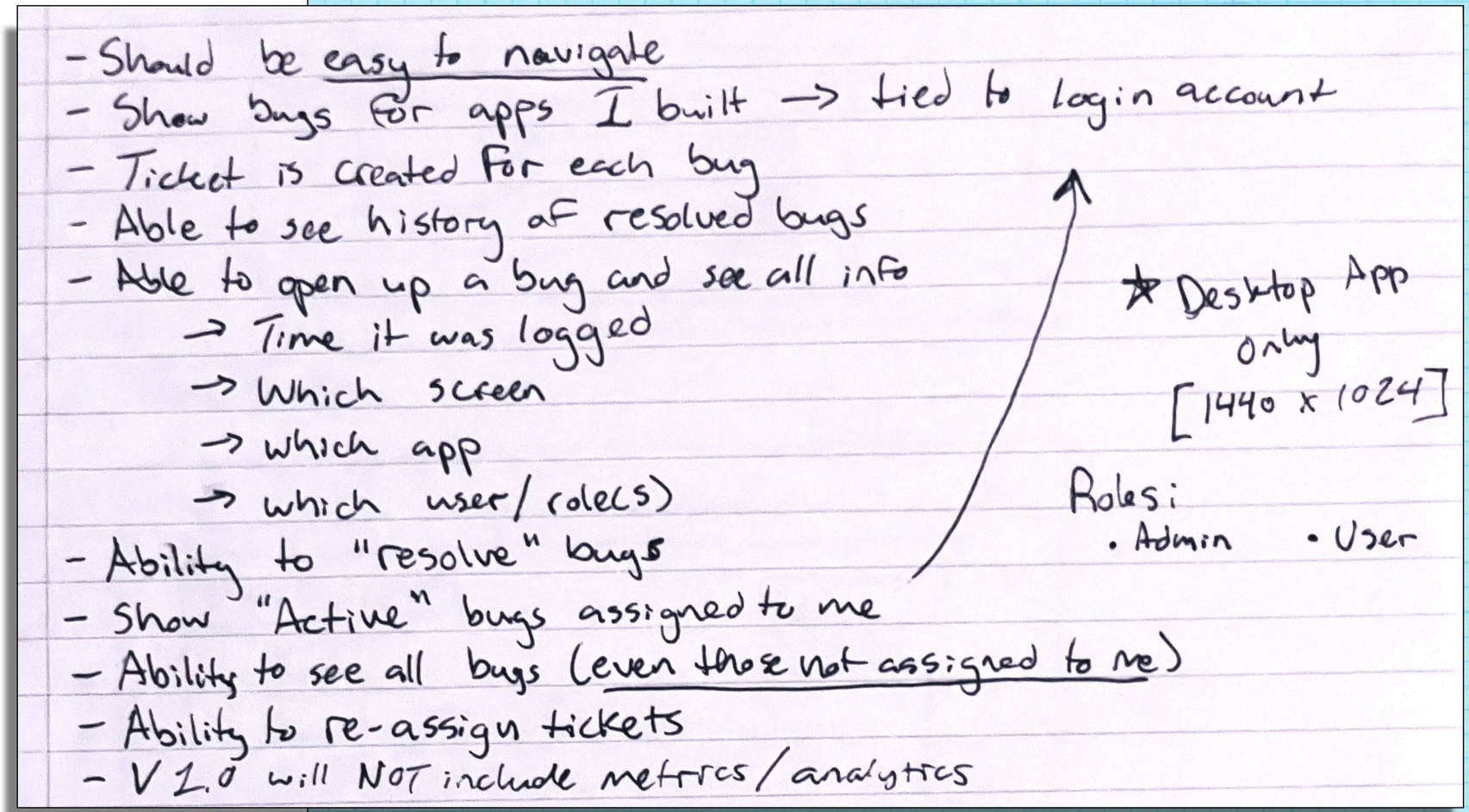
1. Design a bug tracking ticketing system using Microsoft Power Apps
2. Allow members of the development team to quickly see bugs that are assigned to them
3. Allow devs to do the following to active bugs: comment, re-assign to other members, add/remove attachments, and ultimately resolve the bug
4. Allow Team Lead to add new users to the app and manage user roles

4 DEFINING THE MVP

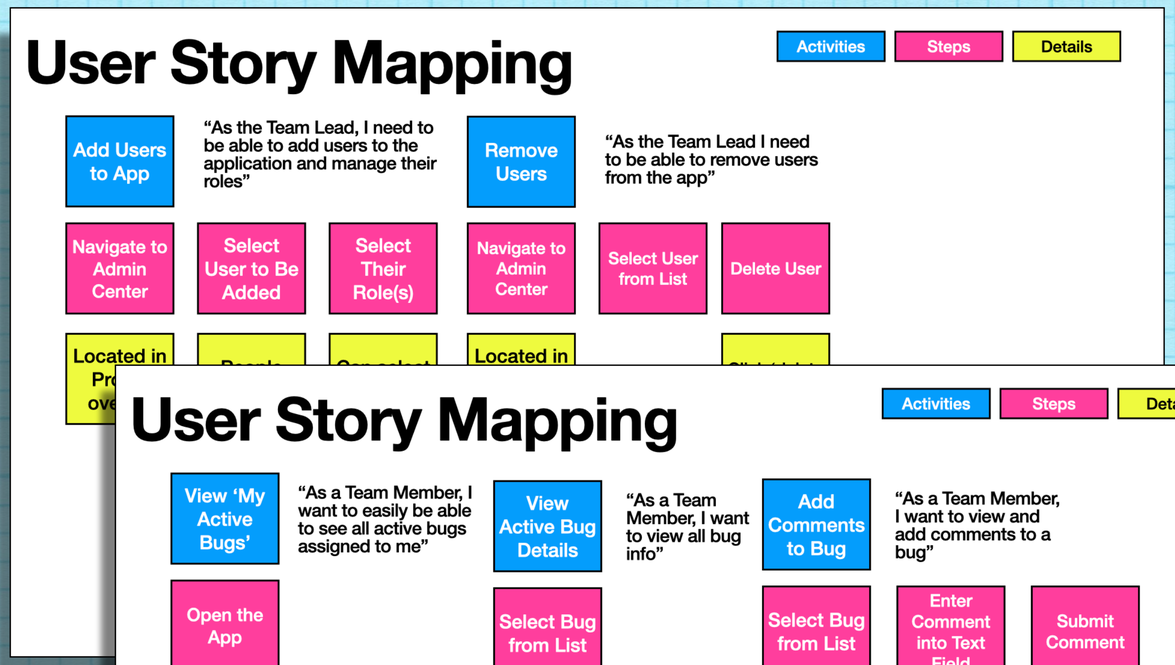
A snapshot of the notes taken from the initial scoping session

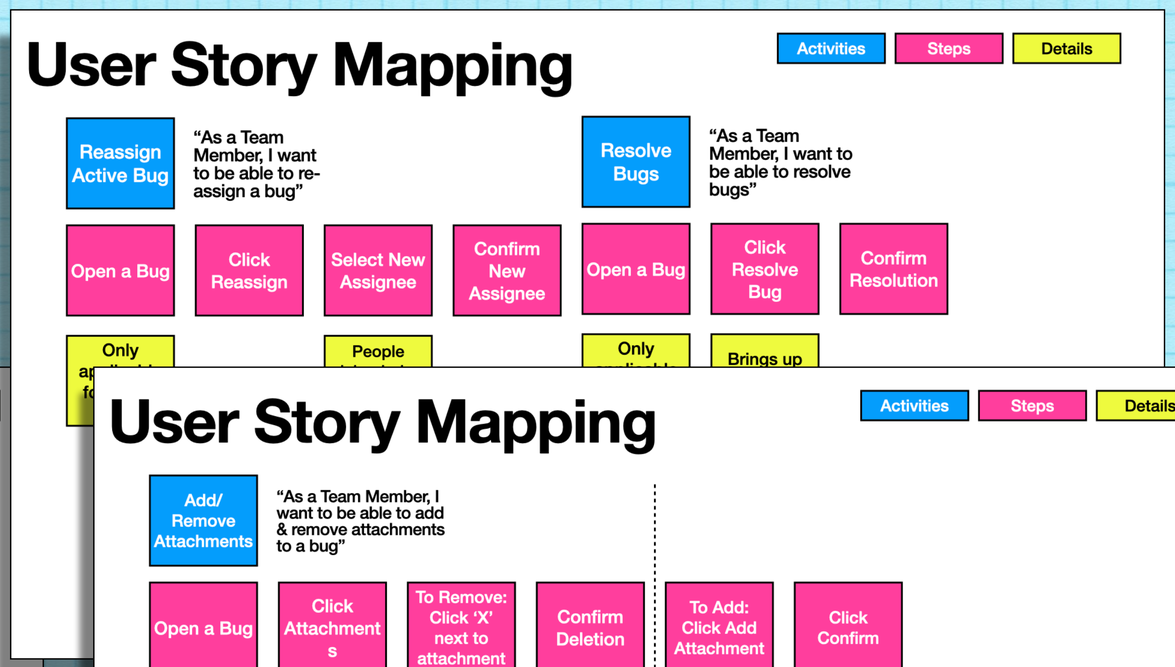
// The Challenge

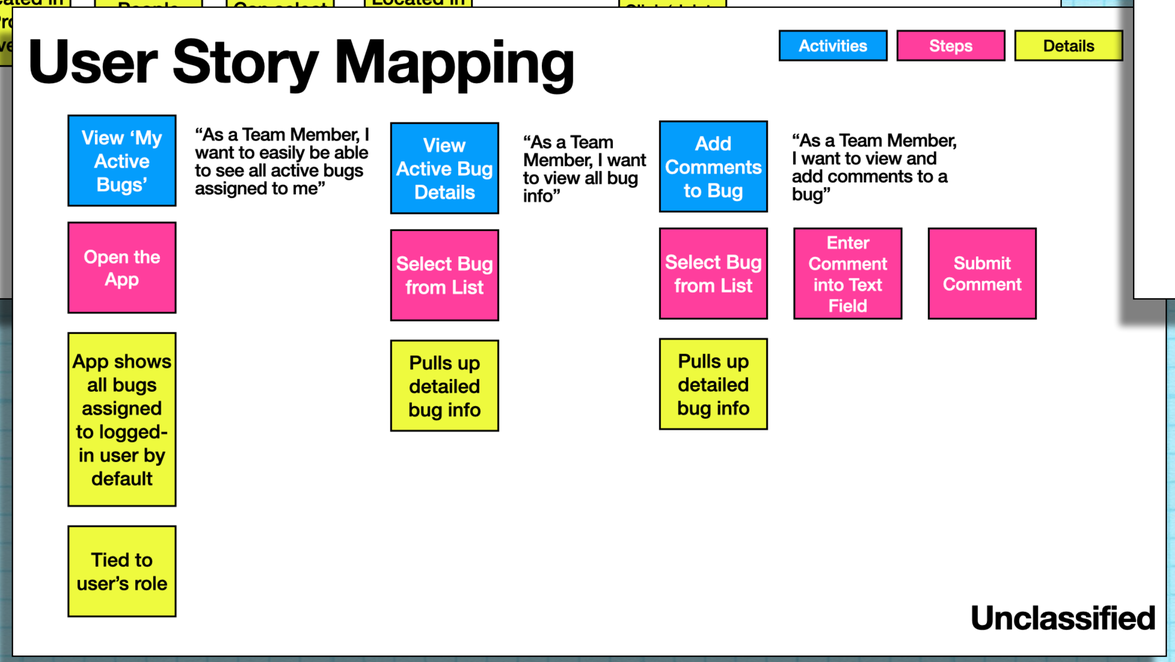
- “We need to build a basic application that automatically logs the bugs from our other apps and displays them to the appropriate developers so they can resolve the bug in an efficient manner”

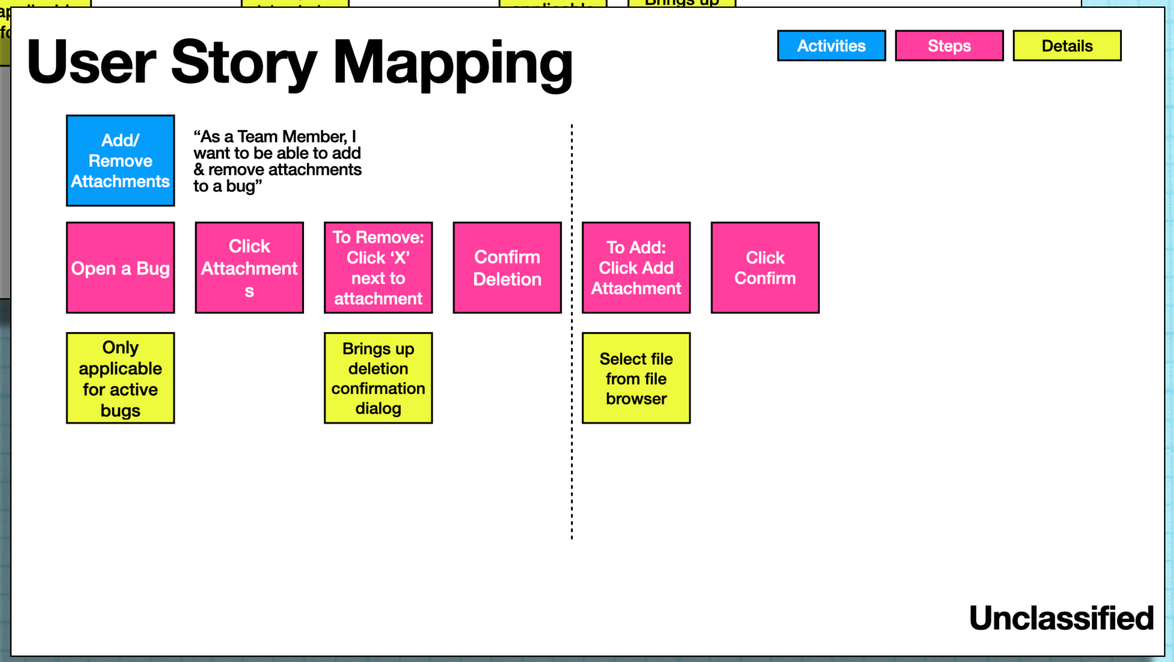


4 GENERATING USER STORIES

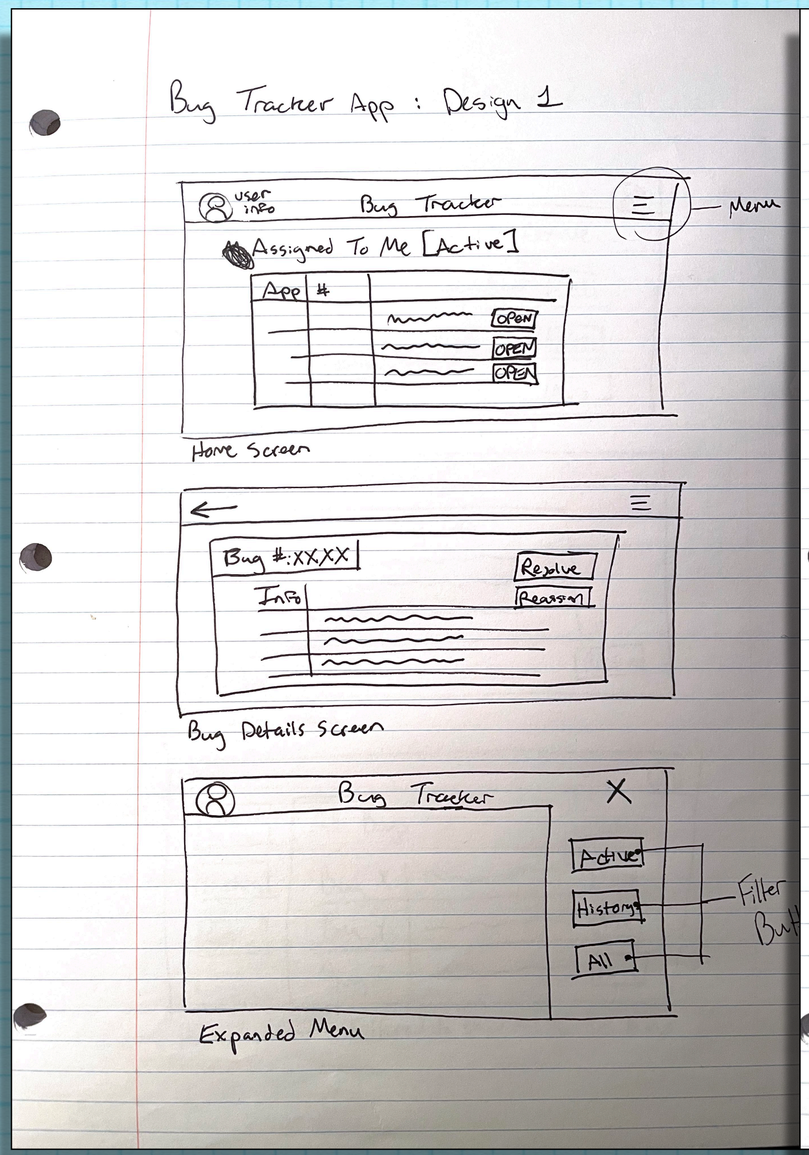


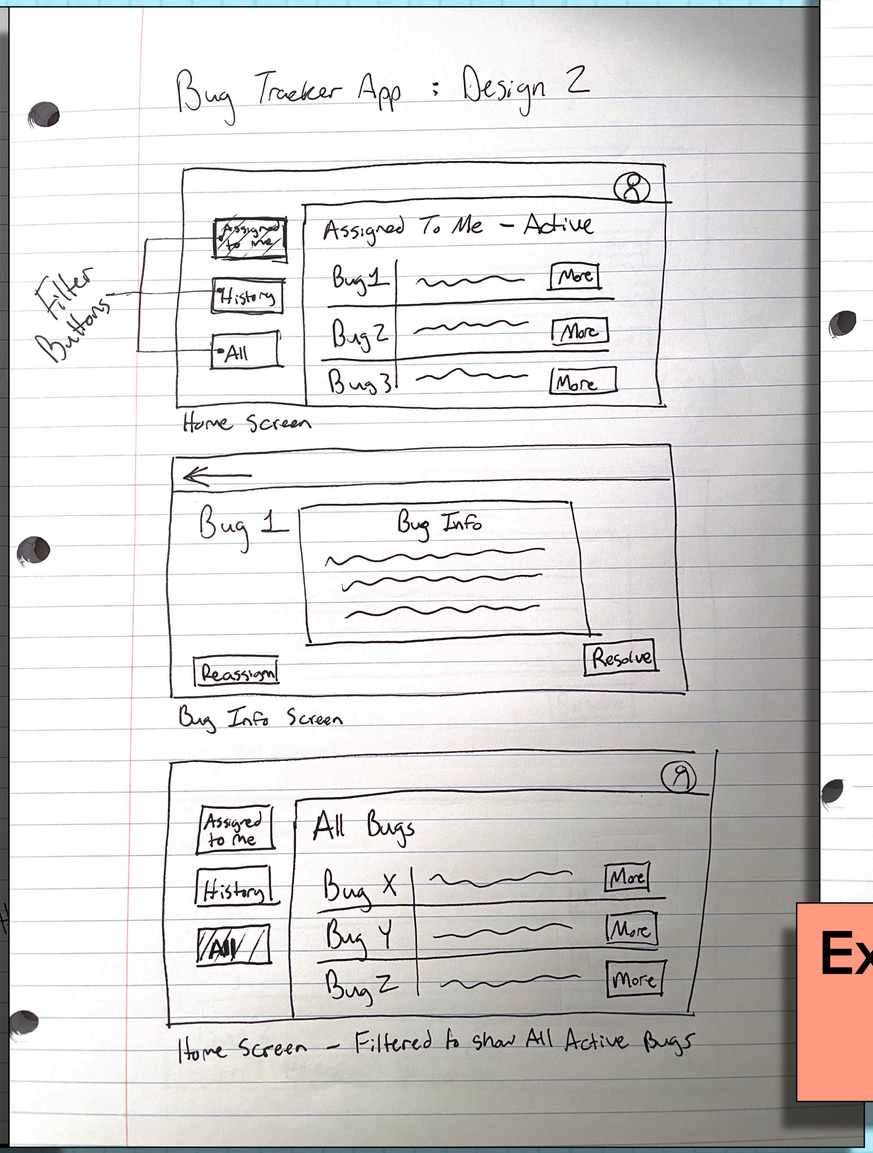


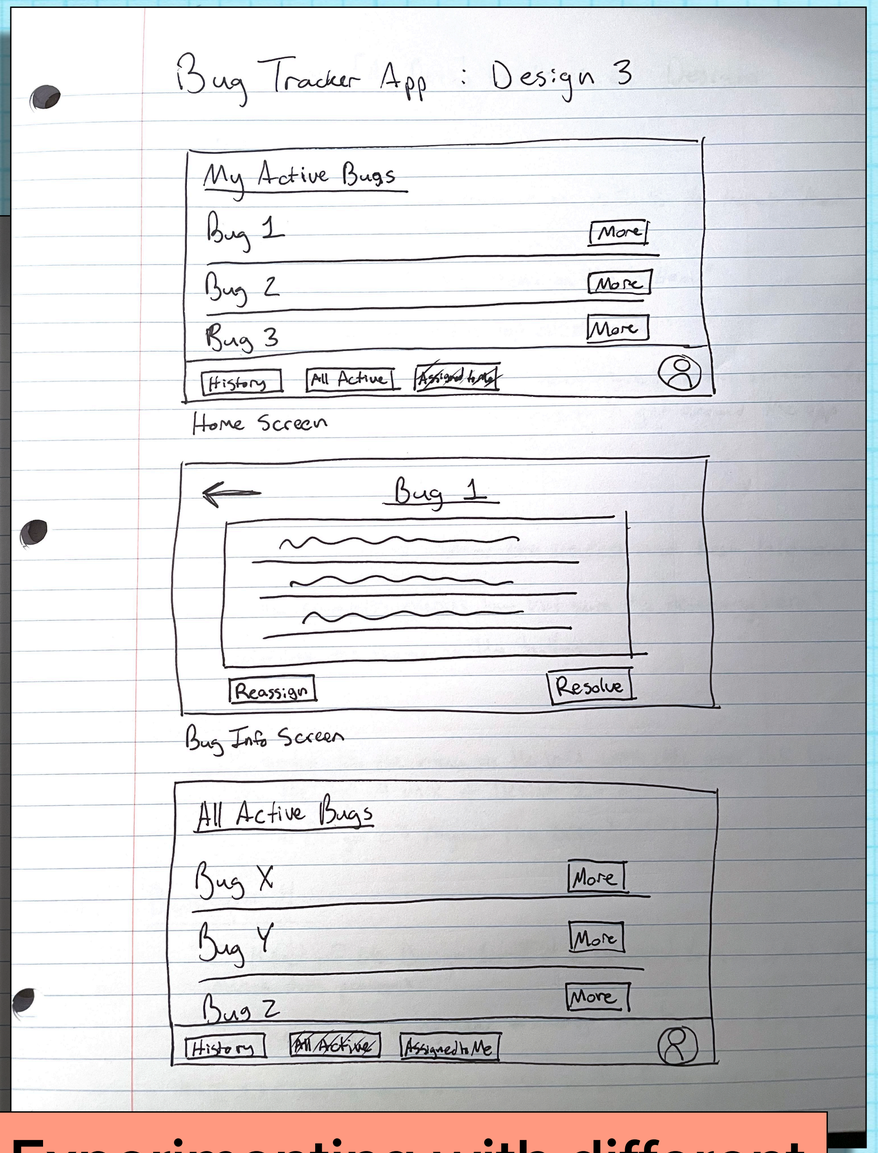




4 RAPID IDEATION





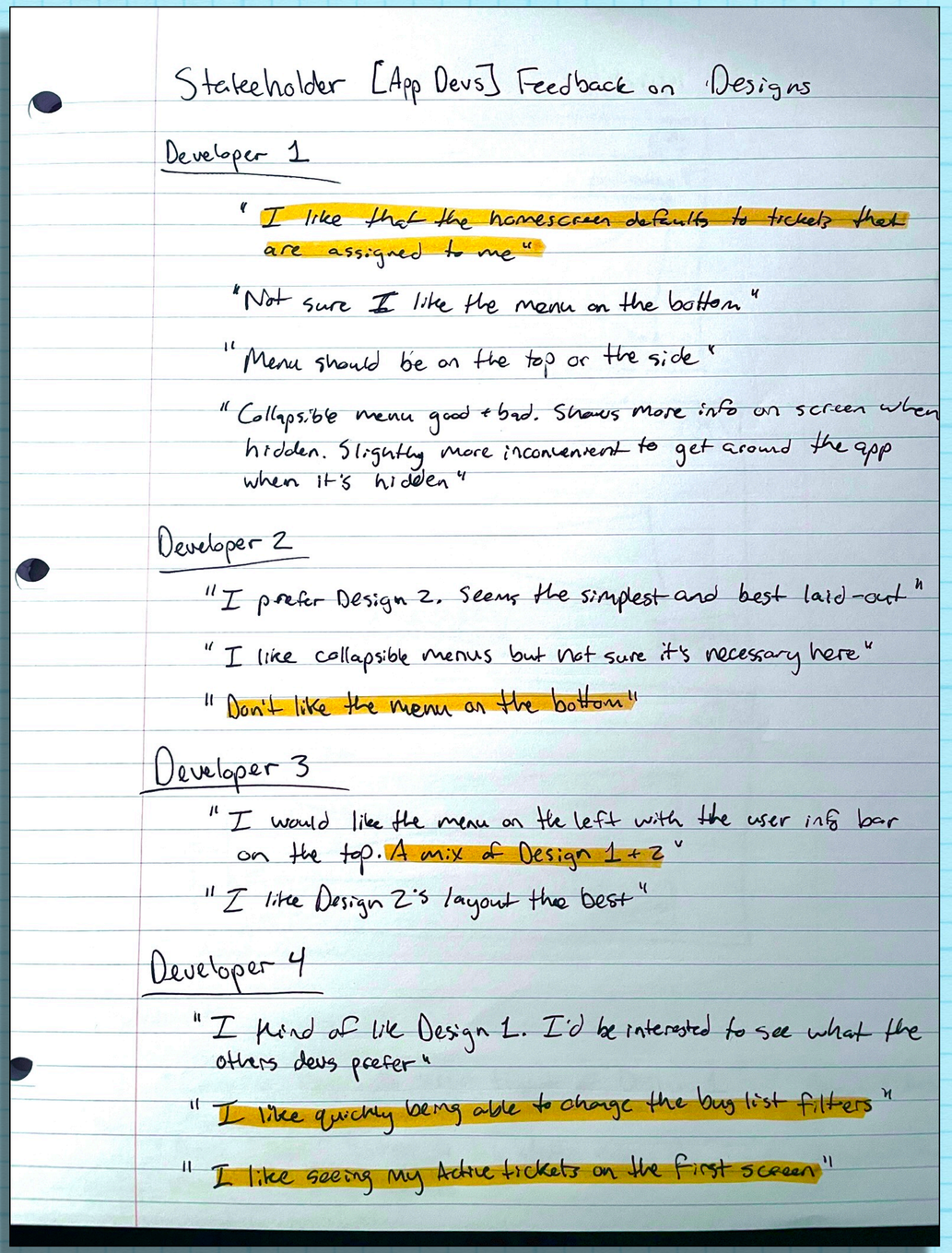


Experimenting with different menu configurations

4 USER INTERVIEWS

// Insights from the Team

- After the initial designs were generated, I interviewed all 12 members of the development team (11 developers, 1 team lead)
- After recording their thoughts on the initial designs, a few key things stood out:
  - Most preferred a design where the homepage defaulted to a view that **showed only the bugs that were assigned to them**
  - Many liked the ability to quickly filter between ‘My Active Bugs’ and ‘All Active Bugs’
  - Some preferred a collapsible menu so that more information of the bugs could be viewed at a glance
  - Ultimately, we went with a fixed menu on the left with quick filter buttons for ‘My Active Bugs’ - ‘All Active Bugs’ & ‘Bug Archive’ that would **dynamically change the list on the home screen**
  - A dedicated **Home icon would be placed at the top** so developers could quickly backtrack out of most stages of a workflow



Stakeholder [App Devs] Feedback on Designs

Developer 1

"I like that the homescreen defaults to tickets that are assigned to me"

"Not sure I like the menu on the bottom"

"Menu should be on the top or the side"

"Collapsible menu good + bad. Shows more info on screen when hidden. Slightly more inconvenient to get around the app when it's hidden"

Developer 2

"I prefer Design 2. Seems the simplest and best laid-out"

"I like collapsible menus but not sure it's necessary here"

"Don't like the menu on the bottom"

Developer 3

"I would like the menu on the left with the user info bar on the top. A mix of Design 1 + 2"

"I like Design 2's layout the best"

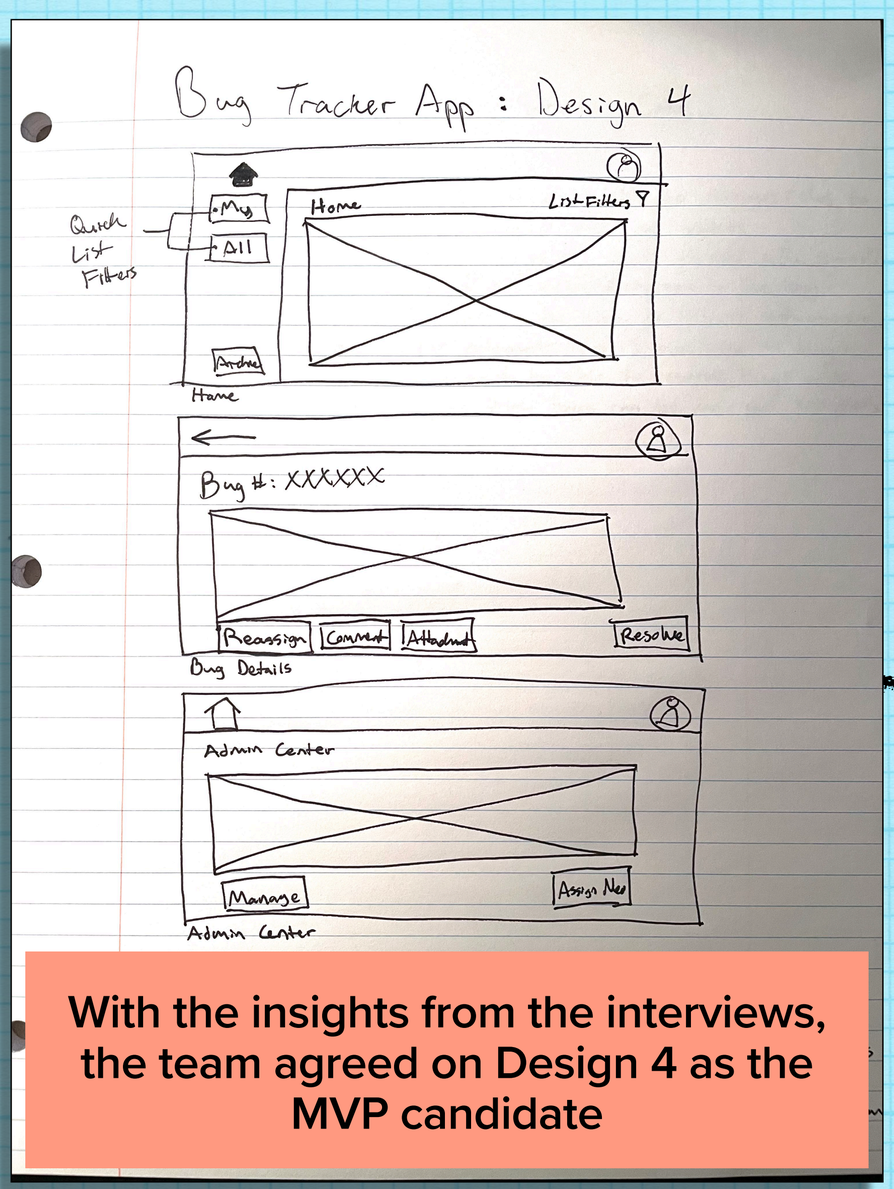
Developer 4

"I kind of like Design 1. I'd be interested to see what the others devs prefer"

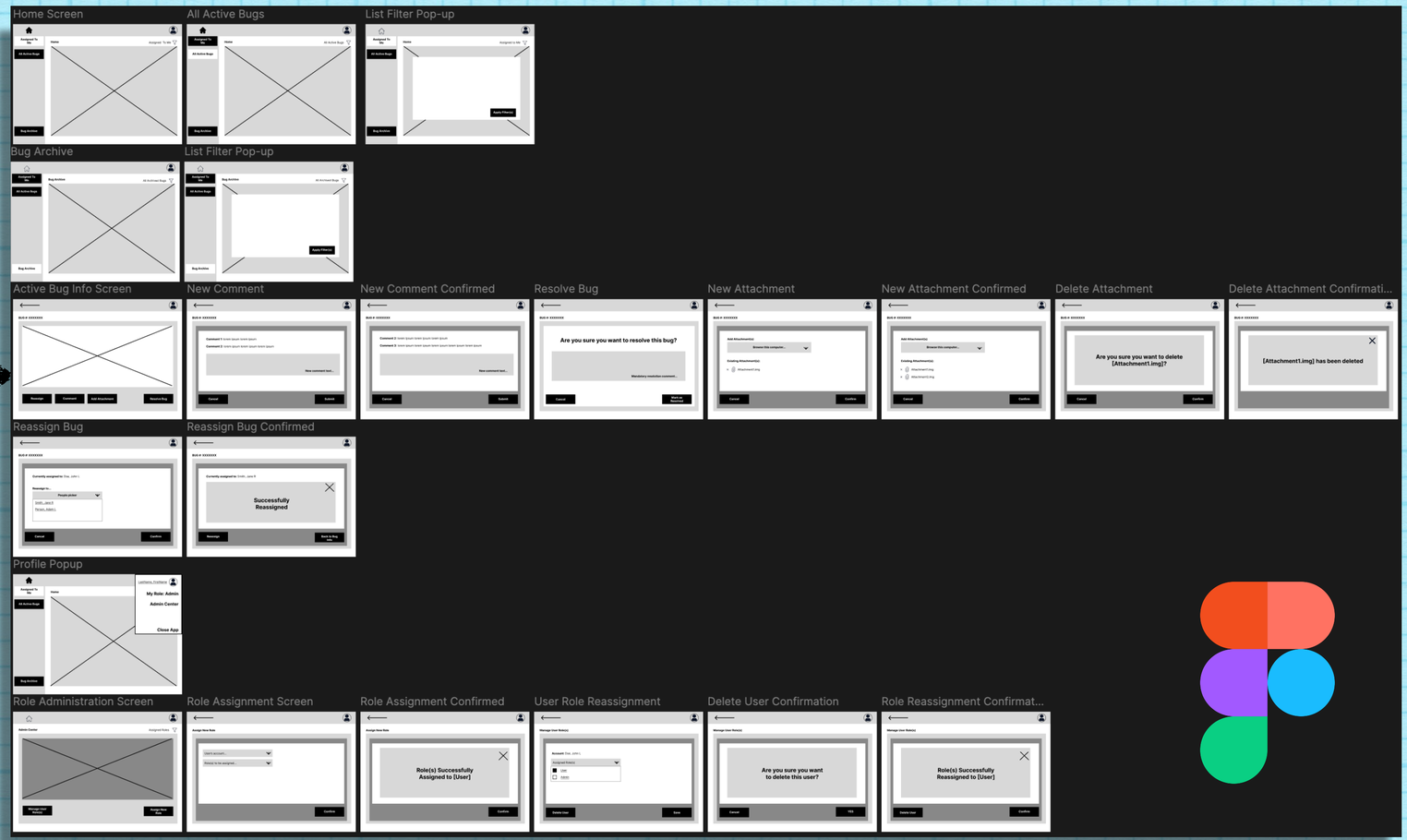
"I like quickly being able to change the bug list filters"

"I like seeing my Active tickets on the first screen"

4 REFINING THE DESIGN

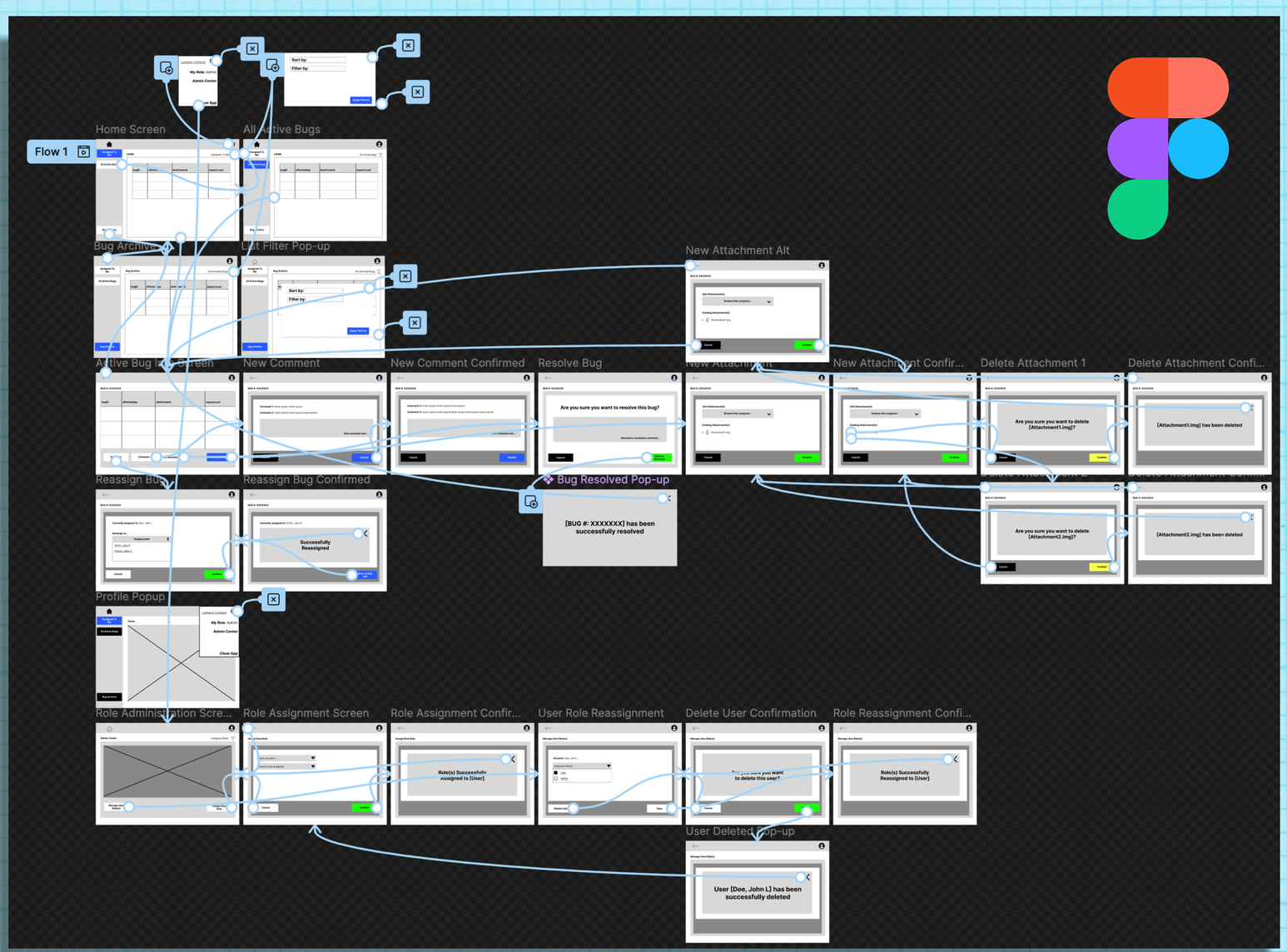


I then took Design 4 and recreated it as a wireframe in Figma. We used this wireframe to refine the layout, workflows, and interactions



With the insights from the interviews, the team agreed on Design 4 as the MVP candidate

4 PROJECT OUTCOMES



// Version 1.0

- Addresses **all of the users stories required** to be considered minimally viable
- Includes the elements from our team's design system
- **Was finalized within 3 weeks of initial scoping**

THANKS FOR JOINING ME

I sincerely appreciate you allowing me to walk you through a sampling of my work as a UX design lead. I learned a lot working on these projects and I am eager to learn more and enhance my skillset on future projects. If you have any questions about my methods, process, or anything else, please feel free to reach out to me. Thanks again, and I look forward to hearing from you!

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